

iQOO 15R

That smooth and fast everyday feel

As something I also noted in my first impression of the iQOO 15R, the sub-Rs 50,000 smartphone space hasn't felt all that interesting lately. Not that devices have suddenly disappeared in this segment, but ever since component prices have increased, smartphone pricing has been all over the place. As a result, phones in this segment don't come with that 'flagship killer' instinct there once was. In the midst of all this, where phones with top-tier hardware have started costing upwards of Rs 70,000 to Rs 80,000, it's good to see a phone like the iQOO 15R breathe fresh life into the sub-50k price segment.

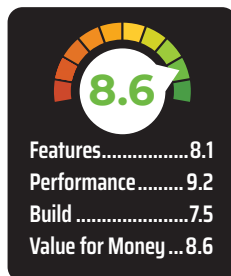
When I first tested this phone in the Digit Test Labs, it felt like iQOO had tried to solve a common problem buyers have: not all high-end phones should be insanely expensive. Also, my early impressions of the iQOO 15R were positive. After spending more time with it, using it as my daily phone and, along the way, putting it through its paces in the Digit Test Labs, my initial impressions have only grown stronger. Will it be too much to say that this phone doesn't just exist for the sake of it? It feels deliberate. Here's my full review.

DESIGN

Let me start with something simple. The size.

In 2026, a 6.6-inch phone, or 6.59 inches to be precise, almost feels modest, especially in the performance segment. Now, most of these phones are usually big and heavy. The iQOO 15R is not that. It sits comfortably in the hand. It doesn't feel top or bottom-heavy. The weight distribution is well

₹44,999



balanced, and that is what matters most.

The Triumph Silver unit I have uses a glass back and a metal frame. It feels premium. The chequered pattern adds personality without being loud. I mean, I find it interesting rather than having a plain finish, but this is something that can be subjective. The camera module, though, follows iQOO's usual styling, but the lens placement gives it a slightly refreshed look, as compared to. Some may even be reminded of the styling on the Nothing Phone 2a. It's subtle, but it adds character.

There's also an IP69 rating here, which gives peace of mind. You don't expect that level of protection in this price band all the time.

Now here's where things get interesting. Its most obvious rival is the OnePlus 15R. Pricing overlaps for the 12 GB + 256 GB and 12 GB + 512 GB variants. But iQOO goes one step further by

offering an 8 GB + 256 GB option at Rs 44,999, making the entry point lower.

And yes, the naming is bold. Both are called 15R. Someone like me, who lives and breathes tech, will know the difference between the iQOO 15R and the OnePlus 15R. But an average buyer walking into a store with a Rs 50,000 budget might not. Again, I'm not undermining either phone, but confusion is possible. Interestingly, that may also mean both brands eat into each other's audience. So, I am really not able to decide whether it's a smart move or an oversmart one. Either way, the iQOO 15R nails the basics right.

DISPLAY AND PERFORMANCE

The 6.59-inch AMOLED display is genuinely one of the best in this segment. It's a 1.5K panel with a 144Hz refresh rate. Bezels are slim and uniform. Indoors, it looks sharp and vibrant. Outdoors, it holds up very well. Now, the company talks about 5,000 nits peak brightness, which is more of a technical claim. In our testing at the Digit Test Labs, it reached 1,825 nits. That aligns closely with the promised 1,800 nits in High Brightness Mode. More importantly, it is a well-tuned panel. Colours on this 10-bit panel look rich without being overdone. Contrast is strong. Scrolling is, of course, fluid. It's an LTTPS panel, but a very efficient 144Hz LTTPS implementation.

Under the hood, you get the Snapdragon 8 Gen 5 paired with LPDDR5X Ultra RAM and UFS 4.1 storage. My review unit has 12 GB RAM and 512 GB storage. On benchmarks, it delivers the kind of top-tier numbers that you'd expect from the 8 Gen 5 chip. But it does heat up while doing so, and this is expected when you're stressing the chip continuously.

- **Antutu** – 3052146
- **Geekbench** – 2706 (Single-core), 8678 (Multi-core)
- **3D Mark Wildlife Extreme** – 3421 / Avg. fps: 20.49